

Machinehead -- Bush

Sixteen Stone, 1994. 147 BPM, est.

Dave Parsons' bass sits low, dark, and driving -- this is the grunge/alt-rock era, not a bright modern rock tone. GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg810 IR (User IR 3)

Rebuilt 2026-09-18 off the GP-5's own AMP + a loaded IR -- NAMs are off for now (Valeton N->S volume issue, device-side). Same target as before: a tube-breakup Ampeg push is the classic mid-90s alt/grunge bass amp move, raw and a little gritty, not hi-fi. Classic Bass is the GP-5's own Ampeg SVT sim, and Apg810 (Ampeg SVT-810E) is a direct real-world match for the discontinued V4B capture's own "Ampeg 8x10" cab.

- Gain: 48 -- enough to get real amp grit, not fizz; the "dirty without being distorted" character. Classic Bass's gain structure runs hotter than the old NAM's 58, so this is dialed a touch lower for the same feel.
- Bass: 60 -- the low end that carries the riff.
- Middle: 58, MidFreq: 800Hz -- pushed for grind and to cut through the guitars, not scooped.
- Treble: 42 -- kept dark on purpose. Bush's mix isn't a bright, clanky bass tone.
- VOL: 65.
- CAB VOL: 62.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 28. A driven NAM at this gain level picks up noise between notes -- this keeps the low end tight without choking sustain on the riff.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 38 when engaged.

Off for the verse groove, on for the chorus. Same amp tone throughout, just louder and a bit more shoved into the front end for the hook.

DST -- off.

The amp's own grind carries the grit. Stacking a drive pedal on top would just mud out the riff instead of adding character.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 48, Bass 60, Middle 58, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 42, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 3 (Apg810), always on. VOL 62.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +4, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: -4, 800Hz: -2, 4.5kHz: +5, VOL: 55.

Small low-end reinforcement, a cut around 400Hz-800Hz to keep the V4B from getting boxy under the guitars, and a push at 4.5kHz for pick/finger attack so the riff reads as a note, not just low-end mush.

MOD -- off. No modulation on this one -- chorus/vibe would soften a riff that's supposed to hit like a hammer.

DLY -- off. Straight, driving part. No delay.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 24, Decay: 38, Trail: true.

Off for the verse -- dry and tight, right on top of the beat.

On for the chorus, alongside the boost -- gives the hook a little more size without turning it into a wash.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- main verse/groove sound. Dry, tight, driving. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- chorus sound. Boosted front end plus a touch of room reverb, same amp tone, bigger and pushier for the hook.

Engage CTL going into each chorus, back off for the verses. Simple two-state song patch -- no need for a third CTL'd module here.